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DESEGREGATION AT LAST

We came to see that, in the long run, it is more honorable to walk in dignity than ride in humiliation. So in a quiet dignified manner, we decided to substitute tired feet for tired souls, and walk the streets of Montgomery until the sagging walls of injustice had been crushed by the battering rams of surging justice.

FEBRUARY 21, 1956
Montgomery grand jury indicts King and other MIA leaders for violating antiboycott law

MARCH 22
King is found guilty of leading illegal boycott and sentenced to $500 fine or 386 days in jail; the case is appealed

NOVEMBER 13
U.S. Supreme Court declares bus segregation laws unconstitutional

DECEMBER 21
After MIA votes to end boycott, King is one of first passengers to ride desegregated buses

When the opposition discovered that violence could not block the protest, they resorted to mass arrests. As early as January 9, a Montgomery attorney had called the attention of the press to an old state law against boycotts. On February 13 the Montgomery County Grand Jury was called to determine whether Negroes who were boycotting the buses were violating this law. After about a week of deliberations, the jury, composed of seventeen whites and one Negro, found the boycott illegal and indicted more than one hundred persons. My name, of course, was on the list.

At the time of the indictments I was at Fisk University in Nashville, giving a series of lectures. During this period I was talking to Montgomery on the phone at least three times a day in order to keep abreast of